

Alex Rivera

Software Engineer

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Backend-leaning full-stack engineer with 8 years of experience building reliable, observable services for developer tooling and fintech platforms. Enjoys mentoring, incident response, and turning ambiguous requirements into shipped software.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer **Northwind Systems**

Mar 2022 – Present

Lead engineer on the payments platform team, owning reliability and developer experience for a service processing millions of transactions per day.

- Redesigned the retry and idempotency layer, cutting duplicate-charge incidents by 92%
- Introduced structured tracing across 12 services, reducing mean time to diagnose outages from hours to minutes
- Mentored 4 junior engineers, two of whom were promoted within a year

Software Engineer **Fernwood Labs**

Jun 2018 – Feb 2022

Built and maintained internal developer tooling used by 150+ engineers, including a CLI for local environment provisioning.

- Shipped a self-service CLI that cut new-engineer onboarding time from 2 days to 3 hours
- Migrated the CI pipeline to containerized runners, reducing average build time by 40%

EDUCATION

University of Washington **Bachelor of Science, Computer Science**

Sep 2010 – Jun 2014

SKILLS

Backend Development: Node.js, Go, PostgreSQL, gRPC

Distributed Systems: Kafka, Redis, Idempotency, Observability

Cloud Infrastructure: AWS, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes

Developer Tooling: CLI design, CI/CD, Build systems

PROJECTS

retryable

Jan 2021 – Nov 2021

An open-source idempotency and retry library for Node.js HTTP clients.

- Adopted by 6 companies within the first year
- Over 1,200 GitHub stars

